

MARTIN WÖLLENSTEIN

Artist & Researcher

*27.02.1991, Germany

martin.woellenstein@gmail.com

[@martin_woellenstein](#)

martinwoellenstein.com



Artist Profile

Martin Wöllenstein is a German visual artist and researcher.

He studied Fine Arts at Burg Giebichenstein University of Art and Design Halle, Saale (DE) and at Universidad de las Artes, Havana (CUB) and hold a MA degree in design research from the Transversal Design programm at the Academy of Art and Design, Basel (CH).

Martin co-founded the artist collective VIVA Comunidad Creativa in Cuba (2017), the creative platform Nnobia Space in Ghana (2023) and is a frequent collaborator of the Berlin-based, zero-waste fashion label IMPARI.

His work has been shown internationally at institutions including Havana Biennial (2015), Nubuke Foundation, Accra (2023), Villa Medici, Rome (2024), Artco Gallery, Berlin (2024), Goethe Institute, Accra (2025), Perve Galeria, Lisbon (2025), CIVIC, Basel (2025), Berlin Fashion Week (2026).

EDUCATION

2023-2025	MA, Transversal Design, FHNW HGK, Basel (CH)
2017-2019	MA Contemporary Art Practice Burg Giebichenstein University of Art and Design, Halle (DE)
2011-2016	Diploma, Fine Arts - Sculpture (1.2) Burg Giebichenstein University of Art and Design, Halle (DE) Instituto Superior de Artes, Havana (CUB)

LANGUAGE PROFICIENCIES

German - L1 | English - C2 | Spanish - C1 | French - C1 | Turkish - B2

PROJECTS

2026

Fashion Show
Permission Slip by Impari
Berlin Fashion Week, Berlin (GER)

2025

Exhibition
Flowing Upstream
CIVIC, FHNW, Basel (CH)

Performance
Gold Standard
Perve Gallery, Lisbon (POR)

Exhibition
Crafting Futures together - Co-Curator
Goethe Institute, Accra (GHA)

Exhibition
Iridescence, a spectrum of research practices in transversal design. - Artwork, Co-Curator
Franck Areal, Basel (CH)

2024

Exhibition
Unleashed - Exhibition Design,
Tinguely Museum, Basel (CH)

Exhibition
Yellow High - Design, Co-Curator
CIVIC, FHNW, Basel (CH)

Award
Next Generation Award 1st price,
HGK, FHNW, Basel (CH)

Performance
Chimères - Stage Design
Villa Medici, Rome (IT)

Exhibition
Feed Me Not - Co-Curator,
ArtCo gallery, Berlin (DE)

2023

Exhibition
Nnobia Space & friends - Co-Curator
Nubuke Foundation, Accra (GHA)

2022

Performance
Growth - Artistic Co-Director
MaHalla, Berlin (DE)

Performance
191 Trips
Release, Kasko, Basel (CH)

2021

Performance
Earth First, Artistic Co-Director
MaHalla, Berlin (DE)

Performance
Soilidarity, Artistic Co-Director
MaHalla, Berlin (DE)

2019

Solo Exhibition
Memories of a past future
Burg Giebichenstein University of Art
and Design Halle/Saale (DE)

Performance
passion.com - Artwork
Institut für Kirchbau Marburg (DE)

2018

Exhibition Series
VIVA TOUR - Co-Curator
Park Platz, Zürich (CH),
Lilla Drache, Halle/Saale (DE)

2016

Solo Exhibition
Die Vulkane im Mansfelder Land
Stadtarchiv, Lutherstadt Eisleben (DE)

Exhibition
Diplome 2016 - Artwork
Burg Giebichenstein University of Art
and Design Halle/Saale (DE)

2015

Exhibition
Casa Nuestra - Co-Curator
12.Havanna Biennale,
Instituto Superior de Artes (CUB)

2014

Solo Exhibition
Monument to the Orphans of Nowadays,
Don Kişot Sosyal Merkezi, Istanbul (TR)

Exhibition
On Orphans, Care Takers & Mandalas,
Halka Sanat Gallery, Istanbul (TR)

WORKSHOPS / TALKS

2025

Talk: Useful Mutations in the Code
(with Nnobia Space)
Social Design Conference
HSLU, Lucerne (CH)

2024

Talk: FieldPlatform / Plataforma Campo
(with Camila Chebez)
University St. Gallen (CH)

*Workshop: We are foreign, we are everywhere,
by foreign legion*
(with Vera Sacchetti, Matylda Krzykowski,
María Inés Plaza Lazo, James Taylor-
Foster, Ananda Jade, Nahom Mehret)
CIVIC, FHNW, Basel (CH)

Talk: No Waste No Time
Stiftung Sitterwerk, St Gallen (CH)

Workshop: Design Prototyping in 1:1 scale
(with Axel Kufus)
Vitra Design Museum, Weil am Rhein (DE)

2023

Workshop: Nnobia Space Training Programme
(with Jana Heinemann)
Social Entrepreneurship Hub, Takoradi (GHA)

Talk: Commoning Knowledge in Design Education
(with Jana Heinemann)
Takoradi Technical University (GHA)

2022

Workshop: Soil Somatics
(with Ageliki Gouvi)
Mahalla, Berlin (DE)

2021

Workshop: Spatial Strategies
(with Marlena Jean Kellogg)
Theology Faculty, Phillips University
Marburg (DE)

2018

Workshop: Participatory history writing
(with Charles Wrapner)
Finca M. Dolores, Santa Clara (CUB)

Talk: Artistic Practice & Popular Education
(mit Jose Madrigal, Charles Wrapner)
Park Platz, Zürich (CH), Lilla Drache, Halle (DE)

Talk: On the case of socially engaged Art in Cuba
(with Jose Madrigal, Charles Wrapner)
Burg Giebichenstein Halle/Saale (DE)

2017

*Workshop: Practicas emancipadoras:
acción-investigación*
(with VIVA comunidad creativa)
Universidad de las Artes, Havana (CUB)

PUBLICATIONS

2025

Article
*Disruptions to the process may lead
to useful mutations in the code*
Published by the Social Design Network

Article

Making a curriculum together
in: Design in the Cracks,
Transversal Design Publication No.1
Published by IXDM, Academy of Art
and Design, FHNW, Basel

Curatorial Synopsis

Crafting futures together
Published by Goethe Institute, Accra

2024

Curatorial Synopsis
Yell Low High
Published by IXDM, Academy of Art
and Design, FHNW, Basel

Essay

The belief system as infrastructure
In: Infrastructuring Orientations
Published by IXDM, Academy of Art
and Design, FHNW, Basel

2018

Catalogue
El Blanco de Casa Blanca
Self-Published

2016

Artist book
Die Vulkane im Maisfelder Land
Self-Published

2015

Artist book
Policromia
Self-Published

Artist book

Who knows Zeynep Çakır?
Sinop Bienal